

Mastering the Art of Proposal Writing

Strategies and Techniques for Compelling Proposals

Why a proposal?



Clear proposal builds confidence & helps you formalize ideas

A well-written proposal demonstrates expertise and instills confidence



Good proposal secures funding

Proposals that clearly convey impact and feasibility are more likely to receive funding for next steps

An effective proposal is essential for securing projects, funding, and partnerships.

Key Components of a Proposal

- Introduction

  Briefly introduce the proposed idea and provide context. Engage the reader and explain why the proposal is important.

- Problem Statement

  Clearly define the problem being addressed. Provide evidence demonstrating the need for a solution.

- Objectives

  List the goals and objectives of the proposal. What outcomes are expected?

  Why is it important to build the prototype(s)? What will you learn?

- Methodology

  Explain proposed methods, technologies, or techniques to achieve stated objectives.

  How will you build your prototype?

- Timeline

  Provide a detailed schedule and timeline for completing the proposed work.

- Budget

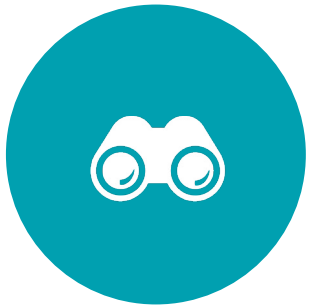
  Specify required budget and justify costs associated with proposal implementation.

  $1K per team for prototyping

- Conclusion

  Summarize key points and reinforce the value of the proposal. End on a persuasive note.

Know Your Audience



Understand audience needs

Research your audience to identify their problems, needs, and expectations from the proposal.



Tailor content

Adjust tone, language, and content structure based on audience preferences for a customized proposal.



Highlight benefits

Emphasize how your proposal specifically addresses their needs and improves their situation.

Knowing your audience and tailoring content is key to crafting a compelling proposal that resonates with the recipients.

Crafting a Compelling Executive Summary



Executive summary provides first impression

As the first section, executive summary shapes reader's initial view of proposal



Keep it concise

Limit executive summary to 1-2 pages to maintain reader's attention



Highlight key points

Summarize main proposal details like objectives, methods, outcomes



Use persuasive language

Craft compelling statements to hook the reader

An effective executive summary piques reader's interest and encourages further reading.

Problem Statement and Objectives



Define problem clearly

Clearly identifying the problem or need helps focus the proposal



Set focused objectives

Well-defined objectives keep the proposal focused on addressing the problem



Align proposal to objectives

Keeping objectives in mind ensures the proposal content stays relevant

Defining the problem statement and setting focused objectives are crucial first steps that provide direction and focus for crafting an effective proposal.

Solution and Approach



Current methods and approaches

List the current methods and approaches used in the field or by competitors



Proposed methods

Explain the new methods and approaches proposed to solve the problem



Feasibility

Provide evidence on how the proposed methods are feasible and can be implemented



Scalability

Discuss how the methods can be scaled up or down based on need

The proposed methodology leverages proven approaches in an innovative way to deliver a practical and scalable solution.

Timeline


April 1, 2023
Acquire materials and supplies
April 15, 2023
Start prototyping
May 1, 2023
Receive feedback
May 15, 2023
Continue prototyping
June 1, 2023
Connect with vendors
June 15, 2023
Final pitch

Budgeting

- Accurately estimate costs
  - Provide a detailed cost breakdown for all expenses. Justify each cost and show how it is essential.
- Demonstrate value
  - Explain how your costs translate to value for the client. Show how each expense improves outcomes.
- 1K per team for prototyping
  - Think carefully what you can accomplish with limited budget; what is most important? How can you get there most effectively?
- Once approved: we need itemized receipts that clearly show what was purchased with a justification that connects it back to their project
  - Remember: You will submit receipts for reimbursement; you are not getting a cash award

Tips for Effective Proposal Writing



Be concise

Use short, clear sentences. Avoid unnecessary words.

No more than 3 pages including the budget



Avoid jargon

Explain terms. Write for a general audience.



Proofread carefully

Check spelling, grammar, and formatting.

Follow these tips to craft a compelling, reader-friendly proposal.

Q&A



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We are here to help!